



FREE GUIDE · FOR FUNERAL HOMES & MORTUARIES

The Funeral Home's Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

Embalming chemicals, trocar sharps, and a family's leftover medications — handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Formaldehyde is the big one.

Funeral homes and mortuaries generate regulated waste that few think about: embalming chemicals like formaldehyde — a hazardous waste — plus trocars and preparation sharps, blood and OPIM biohazard, and often the medications a deceased leaves behind that a family asks you to handle. This guide covers every stream and the one most people underestimate.

The good news

One partner can take your hazardous embalming chemicals, preparation sharps, biohazard, and unwanted medications — with manifests and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Hazardous chemical waste

Embalming and preparation chemicals — the stream most underestimate.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Spent formaldehyde / formalin
- Embalming & cavity chemicals
- Other characteristic hazardous chemicals

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous waste
- Sharps
- Biohazard / red-bag waste

THE RULE · EPA RCRA and DOT — characterize, segregate by compatibility, manifest, and destroy to EPA standards.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous handling with manifests.

Tip

Characterize your chemicals first — the RCRA listing or characteristic sets the disposal path.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Trocars, needles, and preparation sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Trocars & injection needles
- Suture & aspiration sharps
- Blades

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 03

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Blood and OPIM waste from preparation.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked materials & PPE
- OPIM from preparation
- Contaminated disposables

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

WASTE STREAM 04

Pharmaceutical waste

Medications a deceased leaves behind, when families ask you to help.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Unwanted non-controlled medications
- Discontinued patient meds
- Blister packs & bottles

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The funeral home compliance checklist.

☐ Spent formaldehyde and embalming chemicals characterized, manifested, and destroyed as hazardous waste.

☐ Trocars and preparation sharps in FDA-cleared containers.

- ☐ Blood and OPIM biohazard red-bagged and destroyed.
- ☐ Any unwanted medications destroyed with documentation (controls handled separately).
- ☐ Staff trained on chemical and bloodborne-pathogen safety.
- ☐ Manifests and Certificates of Destruction retained per state rules.

QUESTIONS FUNERAL HOMES ASK

Your funeral home questions, answered.

How do we dispose of used formaldehyde and embalming chemicals?

As RCRA-hazardous waste — characterized, manifested, and destroyed to EPA standards. This is the stream funeral homes most often get wrong; it can't go down the drain.

Can you take medications a family leaves with us?

Yes — unwanted non-controlled medications are destroyed with documentation. Controlled substances follow a separate DEA-compliant path — ask us and we'll walk you through it.

How are trocars and preparation sharps handled?

In an FDA-cleared sharps container and a sharps mail-back kit or pickup.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle takes your funeral home's hazardous embalming chemicals, preparation sharps, biohazard, and unwanted medications — mail-back or scheduled pickup — with manifests and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Embalming chemicals / formaldehyde	RCRA-hazardous handling (manifested)
Trocars & preparation sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Blood / OPIM biohazard	Biohazard kit or pickup

Waste stream

The right path

Unwanted medications

Pharmaceutical waste kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Regular embalming volume usually favors scheduled pickup for chemicals and biohazard. We'll size it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY FUNERAL HOMES & MORTUARIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your funeral home waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop